

06-25-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9uXx28Pd8sM
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Target Category	mcs

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Muncie Community Schools Board of Education Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education was called to order by the presiding officer. Opening procedures included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heeter, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Washford, Mr. Irvan, Mr. Lee, and new board member Katie First (noted as serving her first/last meeting in the transition).
 - **Members Absent:** (None noted as absent during roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the Board President/Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript).*
- **New Hires Recognition:** The board recognized new teaching staff joining Muncie Community Schools for the upcoming fall term:

- **April:** Fourth-grade teacher at Grissom Elementary, joining with three previous years of teaching experience at a charter school in Anderson.
 - **Samuel:** Third-grade teacher at Grissom Elementary, a Ball State University graduate and Indiana Academy alumnus entering his first official year of teaching.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:12:01 Financial Report & State Funding Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer / Financial Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the financial report for May, covering five months of actual data and seven projected months. Key highlights included:
 - Projected state basic grant revenue of slightly over \$47 million.
 - Cash balance exceeding \$33 million across all funds at the end of May.
 - Education fund projected to end the year in a surplus position, continuing monthly payments on the \$12 million State loan (reduced to \$9.1 million).
 - Local property tax distributions received in May and June totaled over \$3.2 million for May, with the second half arriving in December.
 - Rainy Day Fund balance stood at over \$6.2 million at the end of May, continuing to be utilized to offset operational fund limitations caused by tax caps over the past three years.
 - Discussion occurred regarding future legislative impacts on agricultural property taxes and operational fund revenue constraints. Mr. Derome noted that outside consultants (Baker Tilly) assist with 5-year projections, strategic planning, and managing debt service rates (targeting a reduction below 40 cents from the current 50 cents).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:17:55 Construction & Facility Updates (Football Stadium & Fieldhouse)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome and board members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An update was provided on the North-side building project at the football stadium. The project remains on target for an August 9 completion date ahead of the fall season. Previous delays involving electrical coordination and easements alongside the YMCA construction have been resolved through signed paperwork finalized approximately two months ago.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No public comments were brought forward during the general public comment period (00:07:42).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The board celebrated the tenure and upcoming departure of outgoing Superintendent Dr. Leanne Kowski, whose final official day concluded ahead of the weekend, and welcomed incoming Superintendent Dr. Reynolds, who takes over leadership starting Sunday at midnight. Dr. Kowski was thanked for her five years of service, leadership through the COVID-19 pandemic, and ongoing availability for transition consulting.
 - The next major budget presentation<U+2014>specifically the “permission to advertise” the 2025 calendar year budget<U+2014>is scheduled for the first board meeting in August (August 13).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following closing remarks and expressions of gratitude to Dr. Kowski.
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